Iran’s help, as we see at this very moment. Its aim is not a compromise around the two-state solution, but the eradication of the Jewish state. This feeds the extremists on the Israeli side and the endless cycle of violence. As things stand, because both sides hope to overcome the other in the end, the cycle may be endless indeed. In this scenario, only international pressure on both sides may ultimately lead to a compromise.

As you may see, I am pushed back (or push myself back) to some optimism, but then, to be safe I must admit my inability to dispel the fog I mentioned at the beginning of this conclusion and again paraphrase General de Gaulle: “I addressed the complicated Middle East with ideas that were (too) simple.”